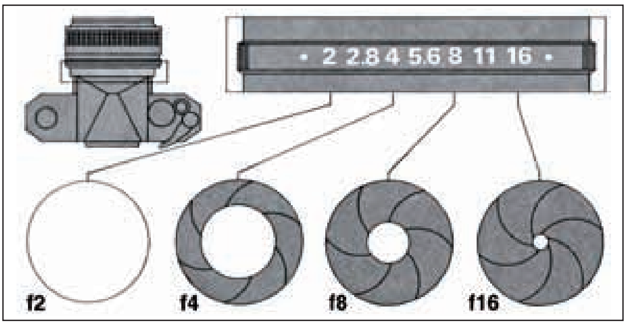
or field of view, if used on a full-frame 35mm camera. Digital and film SLR lenses are the focal length as marked. They will see a narrower range on a digital camera, and you can estimate the focal length required on a 35mm film camera to see this same view by multiplying the focal length by a crop factor, usually about 1.5; it depends on the exact sensor size, but 1.5 is a good ballpark figure to take for most modern dSLRs except, of course, full-frame dSLRs where the crop factor would be 1.

## Aperture

This is the other most important parameter when discussing camera lenses. Aperture is always available as the range, and you're mostly interested in how much it can open, the more the merrier.




Under-standing aperture and diaphragm blades

In the previous chapter on ISO, aperture and shutter speed we've discussed aperture in detail, do refer to it if you need to.

Note that larger aperture openings are defined to have lower f-numbers (yes, we understand the pain caused by this contradictory terminology). Lenses which allow lower f-numbers are often referred to being "faster". This is because for a given ISO speed, the shutter speed can be made faster for the same exposure, since a wider opening in the lens (lower f-number) would allow more light to come in. Remember that the aperture is also closely linked to depth of field, so at a given focal length, a lower f-number would correspond to shallower depth of field, allowing a more creative view of things. Additionally, a smaller aperture means that objects can be in focus over a wider range of distance, a concept also termed as the depth of field.

At the time of purchase of a lens, it's typically a good idea to first concentrate on focal length and aperture as the highest priority within your budget and then